

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Hacking

There's something elitist about hackers, and we all seem to go through this phase of wanting to be one. Well, you can aspire to be one by talking the *h4x0r* talk...

Backdoor

A backdoor is a hole in the security of an operating system or software. It is left there on purpose by the designers of the software, so that they can get unrestricted access in case they're locked out.

Fat-finger

A typo in code or in settings of software that can cause chaos to the stability of a system.

Hammer / Bang

Stress-testing software or hardware to check for security and stability. In the hacker world, it can also mean attempting to gain entry into a system using brute force.

Kiddie

Generally an insult. Used along with the words script, packet, etc. Examples: script kiddie, packet kiddie. Used by hackers to describe other hackers who use pre-compiled software to hack. Basically, a kiddie is someone who can achieve a task like a hacker, but does not know what he is doing, or how he did it.

Mailbomb

To flood a server or a person's Inbox with mail or spam.

Owned / Pwned

A reaction after success. Asserting one's superiority.

Rootkit

Software used by "kiddies" to hack and gain access to root privileges.

Usage: "Here I was minding my own business (just DDoS-ing a few guys), and I notice some strange network traffic. Turns out, this *kiddie* was trying to use a *rootkit* to find a *backdoor* into my BSD box. I *mailbombed* him with a couple of million messages that said "hacking people with quad-T3s is not a smart thing to do!" Then, just for good measure, I hacked his ISP and changed his cable modem config file. He thought I *fat-fingered*, because I gave him a speed boost from 1 Mbps to 10—sent me a cheeky "thank you *fool*, lol" mail. Bet he wasn't laughing when his ISP reported the hack to the cops—can't wait for the papers tomorrow!"

Wild Wild Web

Innovative New Use For Kittens

The item description on amazon.co.uk goes (at the time of writing): "D-Link - Antenna cable - N-Series connector (M) - N-Series connector (F) - 9 m"

Simple enough—a cable that makes lives simpler. Only, it's a nine-foot long kitten. The cable, that is.



<http://snipurl.com/wwwsep>

We're assuming the male N-series connector is the tail, and the female N-series connector is the nose.

Either that, or Amazon has done away with its general policy of keeping product images indicative of the product: you'll notice in the screenshot above that the cable being hawked is in the form of a cuddly black-and-white pussycat.

And here's where it gets most interesting: women are getting increasingly confident with gadgets—79 per cent said they feel "comfortable" with technology. Almost half do their own computer troubleshooting! Really!

The survey revealed, on the whole, that tech isn't all about toys for boys any more. So are women getting smarter about tech? Actually, we think the tech is getting dumber: gone are the days when the VCR would keep blinking 00:00, with no-one having a clue as to how to set it. Ease of use is finally here: you shouldn't have to read the manual to be able to use a gadget.

Taking the chance to toot our own horn, we thought you should also know that in a recent survey, we found that between 18 and 20 per cent of our readership is female—you go girls!

"C'est une lustiger Mistake..."

... I would translate "that's a funny mistake" into "Belgian".

Seriously, for a company that peddles its services across the globe—including language translation tools!—this one is unpardonable. Catch it if it's still up: visit <http://www.google.ie/support/jobs/bin/answer.py?answer=39256>

That's a Google Jobs in Ireland page. The job is for "Inside Sales Senior Representative, Belgian—EU Headquarters."

The "Requirements" list includes the following: "Speaks and writes

Belgian and English fluently and idiomatically."

There's no Brussels Wall, but Google has inadvertently managed to linguistically unify the little country. Belgium speaks several languages including French and German, and demanding proficiency in "Belgian" is like asking someone to say "Tough job requirement" in Indian!

MY BARK IS BIGGER THAN MY BITE! I AM VERY MAD!

Somewhere, someone out there seems to think that's a catchy name for an auction. eBay, of course (<http://snipurl.com/wwwsep2>). We had to throw this one in because the seller is a dog (picture below). "I AM SO MAD AT MY OWNER! THATS ME IN THE PHOTO HE HAS BEEN SPENDING ALL THAT TIME ON HIS OTHER AUCTION AND STAIRING AT THE COMPUTER SCREEN WORKING AND DOING EBAY!"

That's a snippet. LET'S NOT GET INTO WAHT THE ACUTION IS ALL ABOUT! THE SELLER IS A DOG, AND THATS WHAT MATTRES!



MORE OF THE USUAL

Apple Whines: MS Copies Us

At its annual World Wide Developers Conference, Apple, as is its wont, cried foul against Microsoft for happily emulating features of Mac OS X 10.4 in Vista. CEO Steve Jobs whined, "Our friends up north spend \$5 billion a year on research and development, and yet these days all they seem to be able to do is try and copy Google and Apple. So I guess it's a good example of how money isn't everything."

Nothing terribly new about that, of course. They're always saying it. This time round, it's a little sad, because no-one's really

talking about Leopard, and no-one's *not* talking about Vista.

We have to feel sorry for Mr Jobs and his friends, including Apple's senior vice president of software engineering, Bertrand Serlet. Serlet talked about the desktop search technology built into Windows Vista, and compared it to the Searchlight feature in Mac OS X 10.4. Now this will have Microsoft devotees cringing: "We have this incredible technology under the hood," Serlet said, and that Microsoft has "been scrambling to understand how to integrate that stuff."

We think "incredible technology" and "scrambling to understand" are a tad too strong. Copying features and cool buttons is one thing, but does Mr Serlet mean to imply that Microsoft isn't